

K12 Signature Building

Administrator and Staff User Guide

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This guide explains how to configure the builder, export a staff-facing generator, and install generated signatures in common email clients.

1. What is K12 Signature Building?

K12 Signature Building is a configurable email signature generator for school districts. Administrators configure district branding, logos, buildings, phone numbers, and legal notices. Staff members then enter their own information and copy an email-ready HTML signature.

The recommended workflow is to use the HTML signature created by the Copy Signature button. PNG image signatures are available for special cases, but HTML is better for accessibility.

2. Files in the Package

File	Purpose
Builder HTML	Main builder used by administrators to configure and export a staff generator.
User Guide PDF	This usage guide.
Sample Config	Example district configuration file.
README.md	Short project overview and quick start.
CHANGELOG.md	Version history.
LICENSE.txt	Basic permission and usage terms.

3. Administrator Setup

Open K12_Signature_Building_Builder.html in a modern browser such as Chrome or Microsoft Edge. Use Admin Mode to customize the district setup.

District Information

Enter the district name, website, email domain, and tagline. These values appear throughout the staff generator and generated signatures.

Branding

Choose primary, accent, and header colors. You may use the color picker or type a HEX code such as #1a73e8. The preview updates from the same configuration used for export.

Logo Library

Upload logos whenever possible. Uploaded files are embedded as Base64, which makes the staff generator more portable and helps PNG export include the logo. If you use a hosted URL, some servers may block PNG rendering because of browser security rules.

Buildings

Add each building or department with its phone and optional fax number. Staff can also select Other / Custom if allowed.

Legal and Accessibility Notices

Configure Public Records and Confidentiality notice text. You can lock notices so staff cannot change them, or allow staff to include/exclude them.

Generator Options

Control options such as PNG download, QR code support, bottom messages, and staff notice choices.

4. Exporting for Staff

After setup, use Download Staff Generator. This creates a staff-facing HTML file using the same district configuration. Share that exported file with staff by email, an intranet page, Google Drive, OneDrive, or your district software portal.

Before sharing, open the exported staff generator and test: building dropdown, logo display, copy signature, PNG download if enabled, and sample Gmail/Outlook install steps.

5. Staff Instructions

Staff should open the staff generator, enter their information, select a building, choose any optional link or QR settings, confirm the live preview, then click Copy Signature.

Staff should use Copy Signature for daily email. Download PNG creates an image-only version of the signature and may not meet accessibility expectations because screen readers cannot parse individual contact details from a flat image.

6. Add the Signature in Gmail / Google Workspace

1. Open Gmail in a web browser.
2. Click the gear icon in the upper-right corner.
3. Select See all settings.
4. Stay on the General tab and scroll to the Signature section.
5. Click Create new or select an existing signature.
6. Click inside the signature editor box.
7. Paste the signature using Ctrl+V on Windows or Cmd+V on Mac.
8. Scroll to the bottom of the settings page and click Save Changes.
9. Compose a new email and confirm the signature appears correctly.

7. Add the Signature in Outlook on the Web

1. Open Outlook on the web.
2. Click the gear icon to open Settings.
3. Go to Mail, then Compose and reply.
4. Create or select a signature.
5. Click inside the signature editor.
6. Paste the signature using Ctrl+V on Windows or Cmd+V on Mac.
7. Choose whether to automatically include the signature on new messages and replies.
8. Click Save.
9. Compose a test email and confirm the signature appears correctly.

8. Add the Signature in Outlook Desktop

1. Open Outlook desktop.
2. Go to File, then Options.
3. Select Mail.
4. Click Signatures.
5. Create a new signature or select an existing one.
6. Click inside the editor area and paste the copied signature.
7. Choose default signatures for new messages and replies/forwards if desired.
8. Click OK to save.
9. Create a test email and confirm the signature appears correctly.

9. Logo and PNG Troubleshooting

If a logo displays in the browser but does not appear in PNG export, the image is likely hosted on a server that blocks cross-origin canvas rendering. This is common with some website CMS platforms, Google Drive links, SharePoint links, and protected image URLs.

Best practice: use Upload Logo in the administrator Logo Library. Uploaded logos are embedded into the configuration and are more reliable for previews, exports, offline use, and PNG downloads.

10. Recommended Deployment Checklist

- District name, domain, website, and tagline are correct.
- Brand colors are correct and readable.
- At least one logo is configured and has useful Alt Text.
- All buildings and phone numbers are accurate.
- Fax numbers are added only where needed.

- Public Records and Confidentiality notices are reviewed by district leadership or legal counsel.
- Staff generator export has been tested before sharing.
- Instructions for Gmail and Outlook are included or linked for staff.

11. Support Notes

This template is provided as a customizable tool. Districts should review all branding, accessibility, legal, and records-retention language before deployment. For best results, keep a backup of your district configuration JSON after every major change.